

Orlando Insider Guide

Top 5 from a local who knows.

1 Blue Springs State Park

Manatees in winter (November-March), free swimming year-round at 72°F. About 35 minutes north of Orlando. \$6 per car. Get there by 9 AM in winter or it fills up.

2 De Leon Springs

Flip your own pancakes at the Old Spanish Sugar Mill, then swim in the springs. About 45 minutes north. \$6 per car. A real Florida day.

3 Mount Dora

Charming small town on a lake. Antique shops, lakefront dining, lake cruise if you like. About 45 minutes northwest. Free to wander.

4 Seabra Foods

Brazilian grocery and butcher. Real cuts for churrasco, products straight from home. The community spot when you miss Brazil.

5 Camilla's

Brazilian restaurant. Feijoada, picanha, Brazilian breakfast. Authentic, warm, and a favorite for families.